

All, each, every, and none

Learner workbook

Describe a whole group or its individual members.

Understand the distinction

All usually treats the group together: All the students are here. Each and every normally take a singular noun and singular verb: Each student has a book; every room is ready. Each highlights individuals; every emphasizes the whole set.

Use each of the students, not every of the students. None of takes a plural or uncountable noun phrase. With a plural noun, either singular or plural agreement can occur depending on meaning and style: None of the seats is/are free.

Compare the patterns

GROUP

All the rooms are ready.

The rooms are considered together.

INDIVIDUALS

Each room has a key.

Consider the rooms one by one.

ZERO

None of the water is clean.

The uncountable water takes is.

Read each example and notice how its form changes the meaning. Use these distinctions to choose your answers on the following pages.

Check your understanding

Circle one answer for each question. There is one correct choice among the options shown. Check the answer key after choosing.

1. Complete: Every student ___ a notebook. (has / have)

- A. have
- B. having
- C. has

2. Choose the correction: Every of the rooms is ready.

- A. Every of the rooms are ready.
- B. Each of the rooms is ready.
- C. Each of the room is ready.

3. Must None of the seats are free always be changed to is?

- A. Yes. None always requires a singular verb.
- B. No. None of the seats means all the seats are free.
- C. No. Plural agreement is accepted with a plural noun.

Choose the best response

Choose the response that fits the situation. Check both its meaning and its grammar.

4. Every student has a pencil, and there are no calculators in the group. Which pair states this correctly?

- A. Every student has a pencil. None of the students has a calculator.
- B. Every student have a pencil. None of the students has a calculator.
- C. Every student has a pencil. All of the students have a calculator.

Review your choices

Use the answer explanations on the next page. If you chose a different answer, find the detail that makes it unsuitable and try the question again.

Practice online

The web lesson gives feedback for the option you select and lets you try again. No written response is required.

Answers and explanation

1. C. has

Every + singular noun normally takes a singular verb.

2. B. Each of the rooms is ready.

Alternatively: Every room is ready.

3. C. No. Plural agreement is accepted with a plural noun.

Meaning and style can guide the choice.

4. A. Every student has a pencil. None of the students has a calculator.

Every student takes has. None of the students has a calculator is acceptable; have is also possible after none of the students.

Continue learning

Web lesson and related topics: englishladder.com/grammar-concepts/concept-23.html